## THE MIC



**"I am surprised seeing the BSP has not become active. (Mayawati) is very quiet, I am not able to understand. It's possible the BJP government is exerting pressure"**

**PRIYANKA GANDHI**
*Congress gen. secy, UP in-charge*



**"The Congress condition is so miserable in UP, their CM candidate changed her stand within a few hours. It's better if people don't waste their vote on them"**

**MAYAWATI**
*BSP supremo*

TWEET




PUNJAB

# BARAAT WITHOUT GROOM?



*Illustration by* SIDDHANT JUMDE

Words have a way of swinging back in the air towards you and, right now, Navjot Singh Sidhu must be feeling the unique pleasure of being sliced up by one's own boomerang. In the run-up to the previous poll, and even during this campaign, the motormouth chief of the Punjab Congress was continuously taking digs at the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) for not having announced a chief ministerial face. They were taking out a "*baraat* without a *dulha* (a marriage procession sans a groom)", he sneered. But now, all sides except the BJP-led combo have formally anointed a name for the top job. The AAP elevated comedian-turned-neta Bhagwant Mann, the Akalis have Sukhbir Badal...even the farm unions have projected Balbir Sidhu!

It's no secret that Sidhu too badly wants himself coronated. To



**WINDOW SEAT**
*DHURI, PUNJAB*

## COMMONERS VS KINGS

In an election not short of hair-trigger contests, the spotlight fell on Dhuri when the Aam Aadmi party (AAP) decided to field its 48-year-old chief ministerial candidate, Bhagwant Mann, from this seat in the heart of the Malwa belt. The comedian-turned-neta goes up against a popular sitting MLA, Dalvir Singh Khangura, 40, fondly known as Goldy, a sharp but soft-spoken Congressman with a hands-on approach and an outreach to all villages in his constituency. But over and above Mann's fate, Dhuri, part of the Sangrur Lok Sabha constituency that he has held twice, opens up a fascinating landscape that contains all of Punjab's political colours. The Malwa region, lying southeast of the Sutlej river,

